



Defect Prevention and Identification

In this article, we will look at the various practices and techniques that can help you prevent defects in your software, and how to catch them if they already exist.

Many of us know that following a proper procedure during the software development cycle should give us close to zero-defect programs that meet users' requirements. The question is, how to go about this?

When customers (the users who require the software we develop) provide you with their requirements, it's not that you start working on them there and then. You first need to understand clearly what the customers want. Once you have gone through the requirements, put down what you have understood. Then, get your understanding confirmed from the customer. Doubts, if any, in the requirement specifications, must be clarified at this stage.

Do not procrastinate or hesitate in asking your questions. The diagram in Figure 1 pictorially represents the procedure.

While working on the development of systems software tools, I have seen many defects creeping in due to the misinterpretation of the requirement specifications. Fixing such defects at a later stage can prove costly. So, it is very important that you get your understanding verified from the customer before you start working on the code.

Peer review

Functioning as a team is a skill. Delivering a high-quality product is not the responsibility of a single individual. It's the entire team